

Chihuahua, it has to become the next must-have accessory of the ladies who lunch. It's not only the change in the social position of animals, says Andrea Cyrill Khurana, who runs a mobile grooming service for pets in Mumbai. "As more fancy breeds are now being imported, pet parents are realising that they need more care. And since it's not always easy to take them to salons, we offer doorstep service. This is a small industry but it is growing and we've had a tremendous response even though we have not marketed our service."

Kennels in India now offer breeds ranging from the Rottweilers to Saint Bernards and Shihtzus, apart from the obvious and most popular ones like the Labradors and Beagles. These exotic breeds are not as tough as locally bred puppies and need extra care in terms of grooming and nu-

Kat Ferrara A trained pet nutritionist offers special baking services for pets, with cakes made of fruit and meat costing Rs 650 onwards. Also offers pet-sitting services to pet parents when they are out of town. A single visit to feed a pet can cost Rs 550, while an overnight stay can cost up to Rs 1,500.



Pooch Power

A DOG LOVER AT THE FOOD AND ACCESSORIES STALL

The fourth edition of the India International Pet Trade Fair (IIPTF) that just concluded in Delhi showcased the size and scope of the Indian pet industry that is already worth Rs 277 crore and growing at an impressive 15-20 per cent per year. The fair showcased a range of products from exotic foods to diamond-studded collars and grooming products to toiletries. It was pet lovers' heaven as manicured dogs with shining coats roamed around with their families, as if on a shopping spree.

Apart from the incredible range of products, what stood out was the revolution in veterinary science with technology such as ECG, ultrasound, colour doppler and dentistry equipment on display. Dr Man Mohan

Sharma of the Max Vets dog hospital says dog care is more of a industry now and less of a hobby. If imported dogs cost between Rs 1 lakh and 2 lakh, naturally, the cost of the care and grooming has kept pace. "Earlier it was for the love of the animal, now it is an issue of status," he adds.

There were almost 100 stalls, with participation from a dozen countries apart from India, offering unique products like anti-skid feeding bowls, pet deodorants, appetite stimulating pills, growth promoters, foods, designer gear for pets, coats, beds, fancy collars, sweaters, mufflers, shoes and even raincoats. Every dog has its day, they say. That day, it seems, has finally come.

by Mihir Srivastava

PETS ARE NO LONGER JUST PLAYTHINGS
OR GUARD ANIMALS. THEY HAVE BECOME AN
EXTENSION OF THEIR OWNER'S PERSONALITY.



trition. Just a little bit of undernourishment or a power dose of protein can hurt your puppy's health. And if you aren't a big fan of packaged food then suppliers like Kat Ferrara will provide nutritious treats and cakes from her Barkery for your pooch or kitten. Wasiff Khan's Home Care supplies pet meals across Mumbai with

just the right balance of meat and carbohydrates. The proprietor of Waggy Bags, Ferrara says, "We make pup cakes and bow wow biscotti and it contains all the healthy ingredients." With many couples treating pets as their children, the market for birthday party organisers has also emerged. No wonder, Ferrara sup-



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